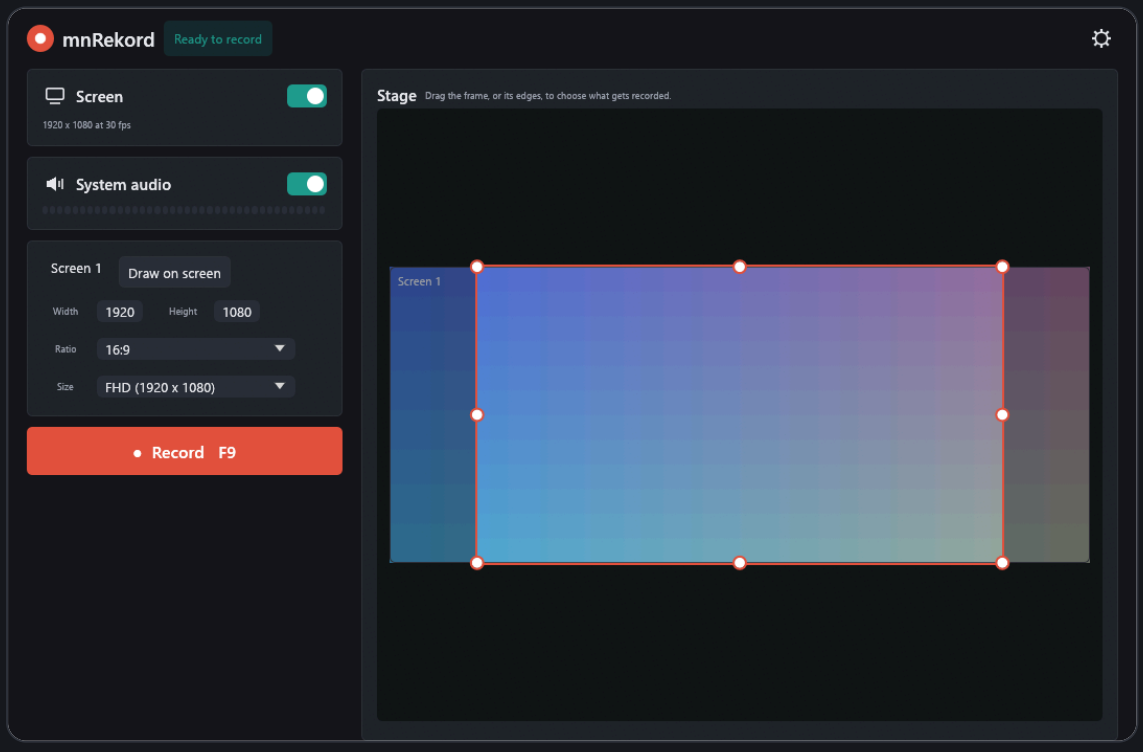
mnRekord

User manual



Version 0.2.0 · Windows 10 and 11

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1. Introduction

mnRekord is a small screen recorder for Windows. It records a part of the screen, a whole monitor or a single window, together with the sound the computer plays, and saves the result as an MP4 video. The window is dark, simple, and has everything you need to start a recording in a few clicks.

What it does:

- records a region, a monitor or a window, chosen on a preview of your desktop or drawn directly on the desktop;
- keeps a **16:9** or **9:16** aspect ratio while you resize, with ready-made sizes (360p, HD, FHD, QHD, 4K UHD);
- can **follow a window** while recording, so the picture stays on it when you move it;
- records system audio (everything you hear) as AAC;
- draws the mouse pointer, with an optional halo and a ring on clicks;
- pauses, resumes and adds markers; splits long recordings into parts; makes a GIF from the last recording;
- is controlled by global shortcuts, a tray icon or the command line;
- offers to recover a recording that was cut off by a crash.

mnRekord does not record a microphone or a webcam.

2. Installation

Requirements

- Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit.
- A playback device, if you want system audio.
- The Windows H.264 and AAC encoders. They are part of Windows; on the “N” editions install Microsoft’s *Media Feature Pack* first.

With the installer

Run `mnRekord-0.2.0-setup.exe`. By default it installs for your user only and needs no administrator rights; the dialog also offers an install for all users. It adds a Start menu entry, optionally a desktop icon, and an uninstaller (*Settings → Apps*). The installer is available in English and Hungarian.

Without installing

`mnrekord.exe` is a single file. Copy it anywhere and run it; nothing else is needed.

Uninstalling

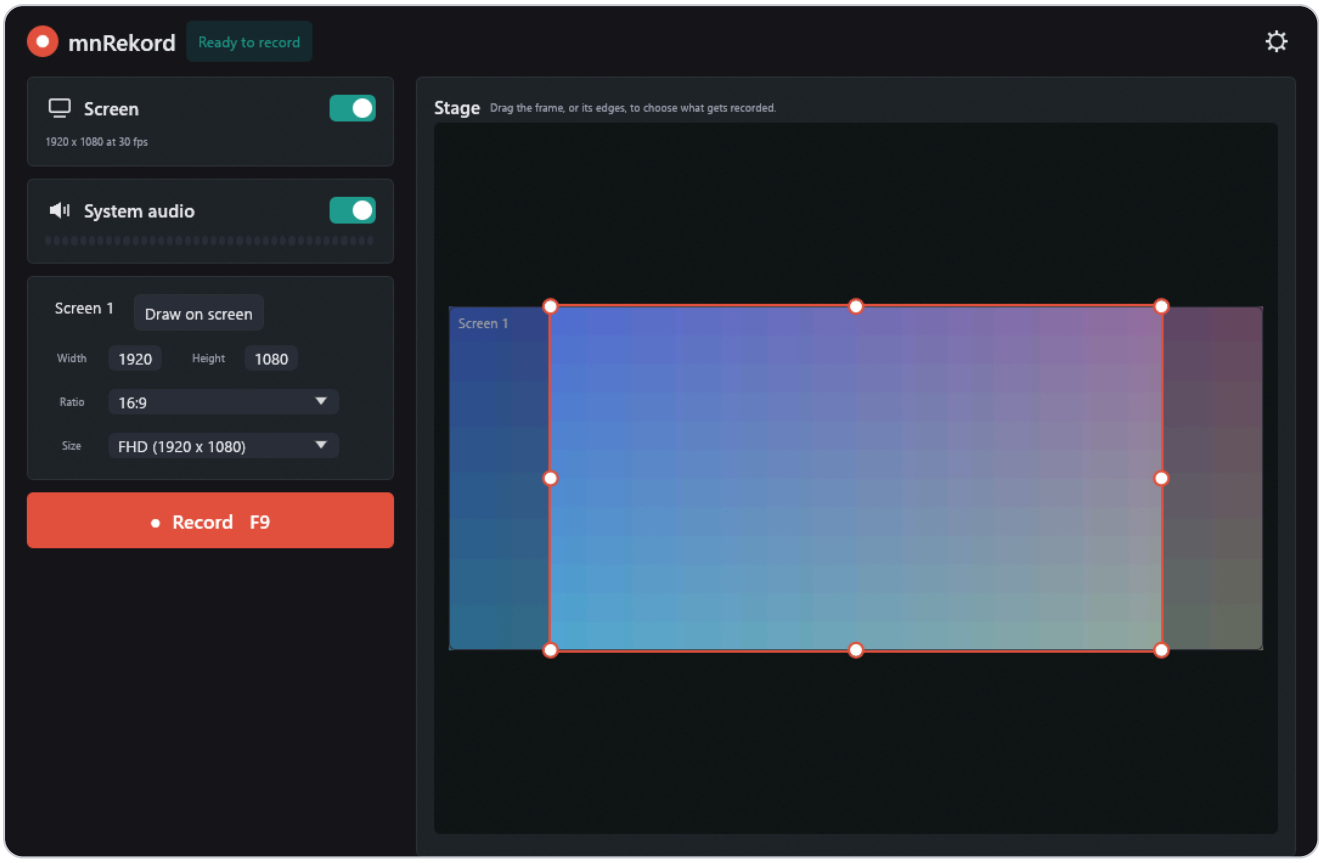
Remove mnRekord in *Settings* → *Apps*. Your settings (`%APPDATA%\mnRekord`) and your recordings are not deleted.

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3. Quick start

1. Start mnRekord. The stage on the right shows your desktop and a frame; the frame is what will be recorded.
2. Drag the frame or its handles to cover what you want to record. Or click **Screen 1** to record a whole monitor, or **Draw on screen** to click a window.
3. Pick a size with **Ratio** and **Size**, for example *16:9* and *FHD*.
4. Press **Record** (or `F9`). A 3-2-1 countdown starts, and the window turns into a slim bar.
5. Press **Stop** (or `F10`). The video is saved in `Documents\mnRekord` and opens in your video player.

4. The main window



The main window. The picture on the stage is a demo picture.

PART	WHAT IT DOES
Status (top, next to the name)	“Ready to record” when a recording can start.
Gear (top right)	Opens the Preferences.
Screen card	Switch for recording the screen. Shows the size and frame rate of the video, for example *1920 x 1080 at 30 fps*.
System audio card	Switch for recording the sound the computer plays, with a level meter that moves while something is playing.
Region card	Monitors, **Draw on screen**, width and height, **Ratio**, **Size** and **Follow**. See Choosing what to record.
Record button	Starts the recording. Shows the shortcut (`F9`). It is grey when nothing is switched on to record.
Last recording and **Make GIF**	Appear under the Record button after a recording, when “Exit after stopped” is switched off (otherwise mnRekord has already quit). See Recordings and files.
Stage	A live picture of all your monitors, with the frame you are going to record.

> **Note**
> The stage refreshes about 30 times a second and stops while the window is minimized. The recorder’s own window is hidden from the picture.

5. Choosing what to record

The frame on the stage

- **Move:** drag inside the frame.
- **Resize:** drag one of the eight handles (four corners, four edge middles).
- With a locked ratio, a **corner** grows from the opposite corner, following the mouse in any direction. An **edge** grows around the middle of the frame, and the frame is pushed back inside the screen when it would leave it, so a handle never gets stuck.

- With **Free** ratio the edges and corners resize the frame without any constraint.

Monitors

The **Screen 1**, **Screen 2** … buttons select a whole monitor. With a locked ratio the largest frame of that ratio fits in the monitor, centred.

Draw on screen

The window disappears and a still picture of your desktop covers the screen. Then:

- **click** a window or a monitor to record it (a window is recorded as it is placed at the moment, with its visible frame);
- or **drag** a rectangle; a magnifier next to the pointer helps you hit the exact pixel;
- `Esc` cancels.

When you pick a window, the **Follow** switch appears (see below).

Ratio and size

The **Ratio** list is the base setting: *16:9*, *9:16* or *Free*. With 16:9 or 9:16 the frame always keeps that ratio, whatever you do with it, and the **Size** list offers sizes of that ratio:

NAME	16:9	9:16
360p	640 × 360	360 × 640
HD	1280 × 720	720 × 1280
FHD	1920 × 1080	1080 × 1920
QHD	2560 × 1440	1440 × 2560
4K UHD	3840 × 2160	2160 × 3840

Sizes bigger than your screen are greyed out. Picking a size keeps the centre of the frame where it is. With **Free** the list offers AD (600 × 315), SD, HD, FHD, 2K, QHD and 4K UHD.

Width and **Height** are numbers you can drag or type. With a locked ratio changing one changes the other. The video is always an even number of pixels wide and high, because H.264 needs that.

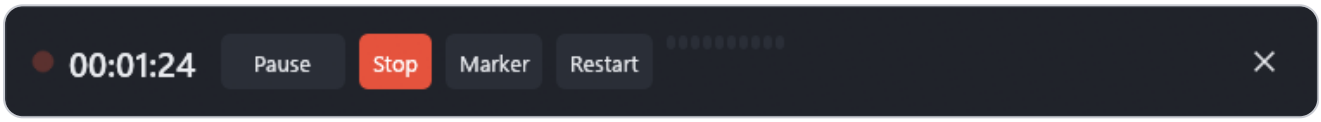
Follow a window

When the region was picked by clicking a window, the **Follow** switch appears under **Size**. If it is on, the frame keeps its place *inside the window* during the recording: move the window and the picture moves with it. The frame keeps its size. A minimized or closed window is not followed; the frame stays where it was last seen.

The same can be done from the command line, see `followwindow`. Selecting a monitor or drawing a rectangle switches following off.

---

6. Recording



The recording bar: timer, Pause, Stop, Marker, Restart, a level meter and a close button.

Start

Press **Record** or `F9`. After a short delay the numbers 3, 2, 1 appear on the recorded region (you can switch the countdown off). The window shrinks to a slim bar, which you can drag anywhere. By default it is excluded from the recording, so it never appears in the video. When “Show region indicator” is on, a thin frame marks the recorded area on the desktop (it is not recorded either).

The bar

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Timer	Recorded time. The dot blinks while recording and is amber while paused.
Pause / **Resume**	Pauses and continues. Paused time is not in the video. (Shortcut: `F9`.)
Stop	Ends the recording and saves it. (Shortcut: `F10`.)
Marker	Notes the current time in a text file next to the video. (Shortcut: `Ctrl` + `M`.)
Restart	Asks whether to delete the recording so far; if you agree, you are back in the main window to start again.
Meter	The level of the system audio.
✕	Asks whether to delete this recording and quit.

The window title also shows the state, so the taskbar tells you even when the bar is hidden: `● 00:01:24 mnRekord` while recording and `Paused 00:01:24 mnRekord` while paused.

Pause and the mouse

If “Restore cursor location after pause” is on (the default), the mouse pointer jumps back to where it was when you paused, once you resume.

Stop and save

After **Stop** the recording is saved in the output folder, named after the file name template. If “Prompt for file name” is selected, a Save dialog asks for the name. With the defaults, the recording is then opened in your video player and mnRekord quits (“Exit after stopped”, “Open recording after stopped”).

If you stop during the countdown, nothing is saved.

Low disk space

If less than about 300 MB is free on the drive of the temporary folder, the recording stops by itself and what was recorded so far is saved.

7. Recordings and files

The video

MP4 with H.264 video (Main profile) and AAC stereo audio at 48 kHz. The file is written in fragments, so even a recording cut short by a crash plays up to the last fragment.

File names

The name comes from a template (Preferences → Files). The default is `Rec {date} {time}`, which gives `Rec 2026-11-07 14-05-09.mp4`.

TOKEN	REPLACED BY
`{date}`	The date, `2026-11-07`
`{time}`	The time, `14-05-09`
`{window}`	The title of the window you picked on screen, or `screen`

Characters that are not allowed in file names are replaced by `_`. If a file with that name exists, `(1)`, `(2)` … is added.

Markers

If you added markers, a text file `name.markers.txt` is saved next to the video, one line per marker: the time and the marker's number, separated by a tab, for example `00:01:12.500  Marker 1`. Markers are only recorded when the screen is recorded.

Split recordings

With **Start a new file every N min** (Preferences → Inputs) a long recording is cut into parts. When a part is full, the next file starts at once and the finished part is closed. The files are named `name-part1.mp4`, `name-part2.mp4` … and each one plays by itself. Paused time does not count. If a crash happens, only the part being written is at risk.

GIF

When "Exit after stopped" is off, mnRekord stays open after a recording and shows **Make GIF** under the Record button. It turns the last recording into an animated GIF next to it. The GIF is at most 640 pixels wide, 12 frames a second, and uses the first 30 seconds. GIFs

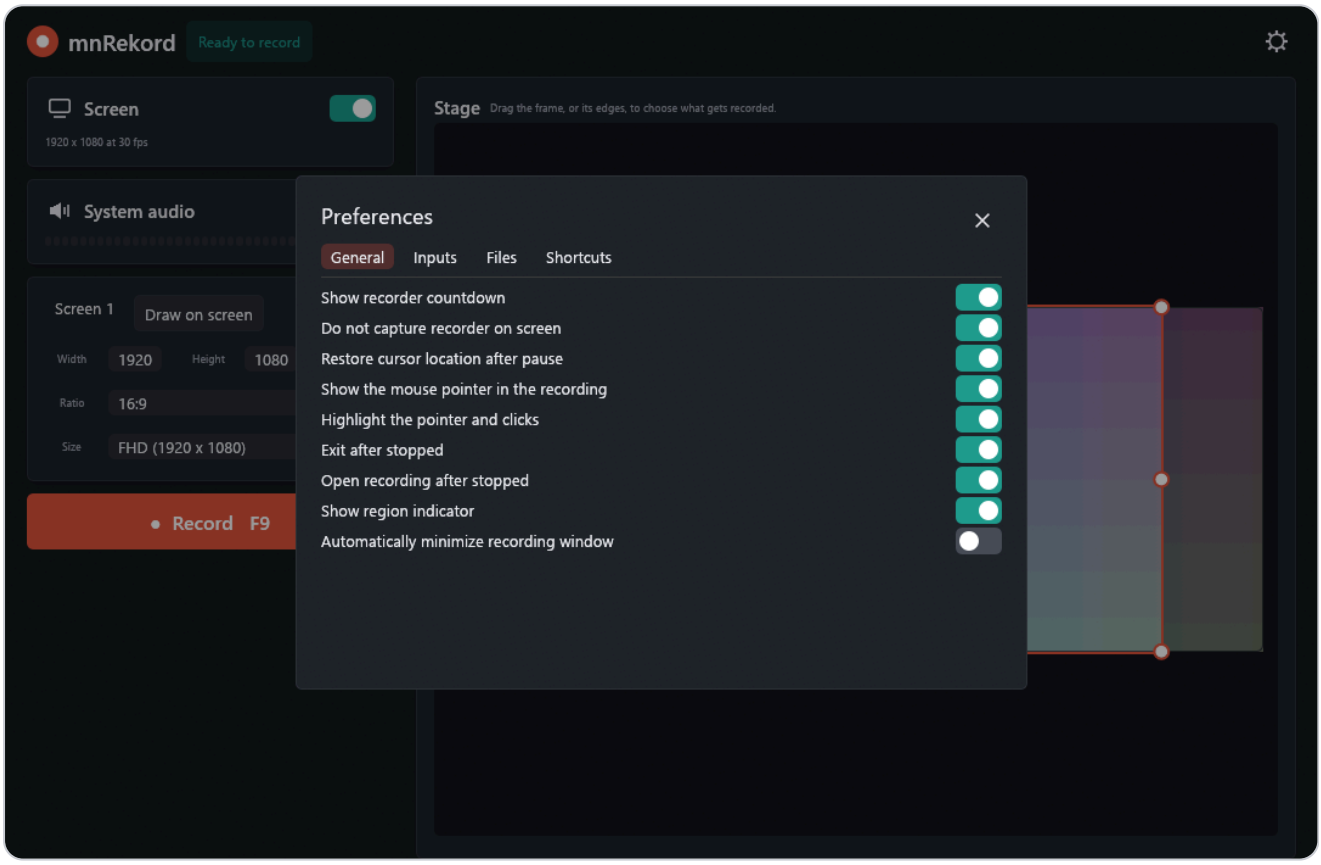
are big files; a 30-second picture can be over 10 MB. Making it takes a few seconds, and the folder opens when it is ready. For a split recording the GIF is made from the first part.

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8. Preferences

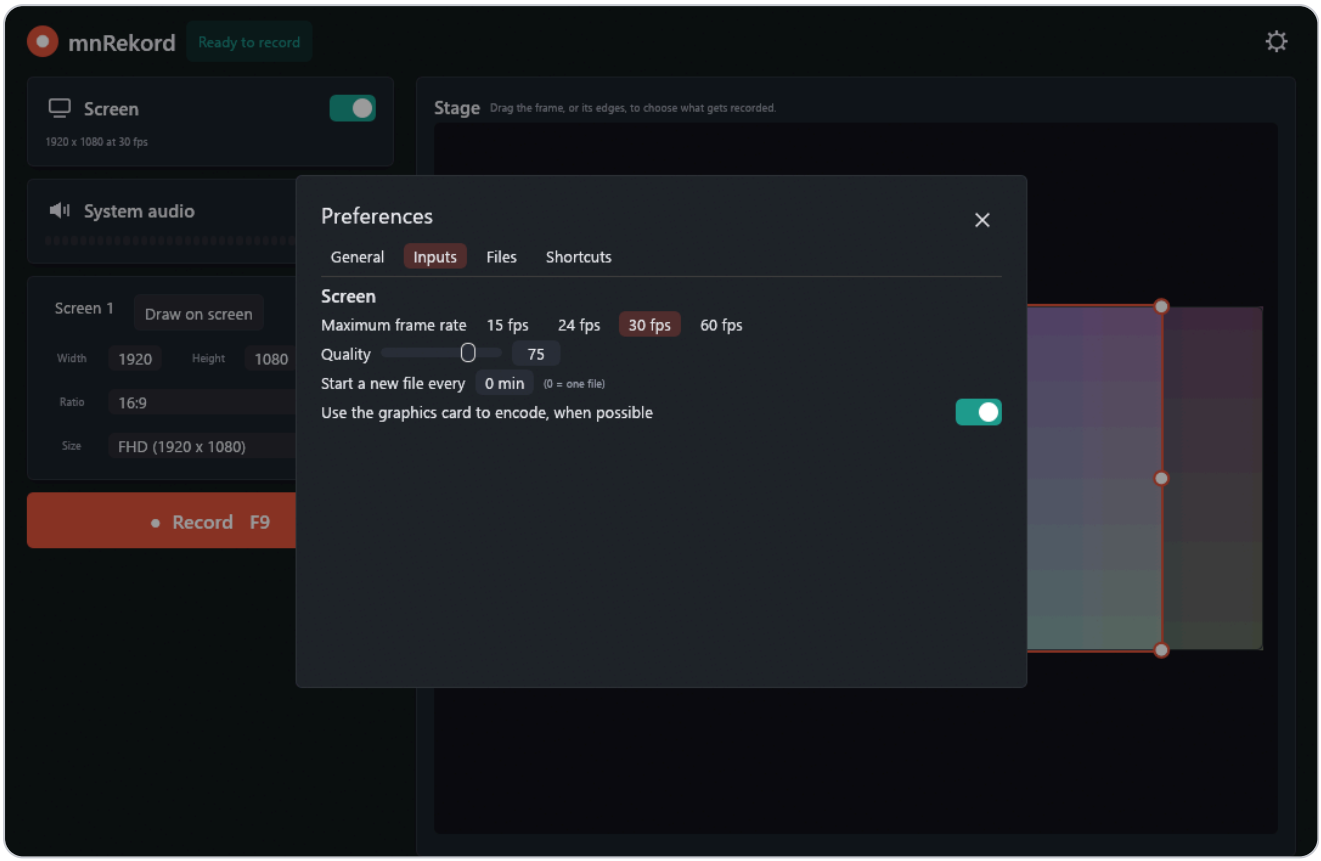
Open them with the gear. Most changes apply at once; everything is saved when you close the Preferences.

General



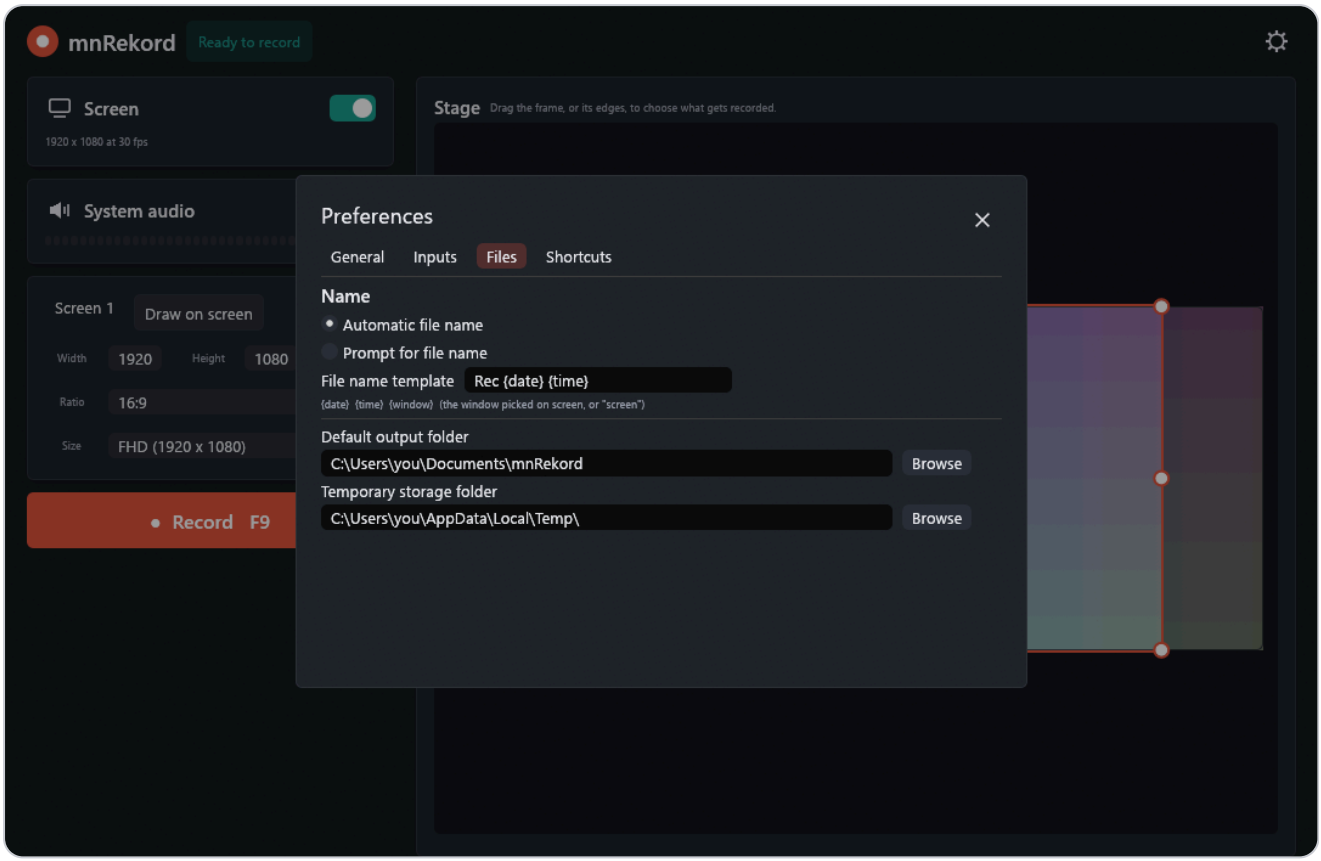
SETTING	MEANING
Show recorder countdown	The 3-2-1 before the recording starts.
Do not capture recorder on screen	Hides mnRekord's own windows (bar, countdown, region frame) from the video.
Restore cursor location after pause	Moves the pointer back where it was when you resume.
Show the mouse pointer in the recording	Draws the pointer into the video.
Highlight the pointer and clicks	A soft yellow halo around the pointer, and a red ring while a mouse button is held down.
Exit after stopped	Quits mnRekord when the recording is saved.
Open recording after stopped	Opens the saved file in the default player.
Show region indicator	A thin frame on the desktop around the region while it is not the whole monitor.
Automatically minimize recording window	Hides the bar when the recording starts (use the shortcuts or the tray icon).

Inputs



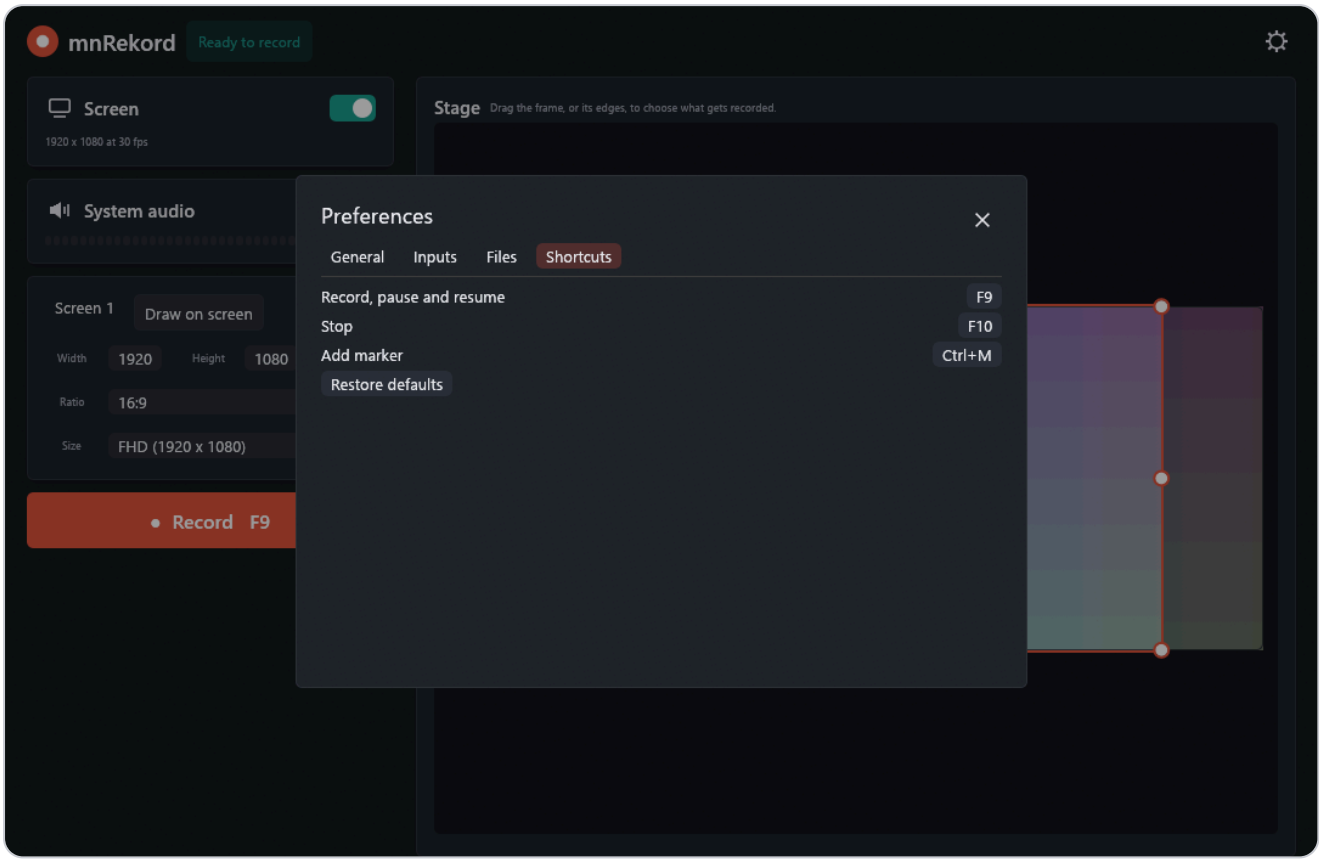
SETTING	MEANING
Maximum frame rate	15, 24, 30 or 60 frames a second.
Quality	1 to 100, default 75. Higher is sharper and gives bigger files. On a test clip with moving colour bars, quality 20 gave about 1 MB and quality 90 about 8 MB for the same ten seconds.
Start a new file every	Minutes after which a new part starts; 0 means one file. See Split recordings.
Use the graphics card to encode	Lets Windows use the GPU's H.264 encoder when there is one. After a recording the name of the encoder that was used is shown here. Switch it off if you have problems with a graphics driver.

Files



SETTING	MEANING
Automatic file name / Prompt for file name	Save under the template's name, or ask in a Save dialog.
File name template	With `{date}`, `{time}`, `{window}`.
Default output folder	Where recordings are saved. Default `Documents\mnRekord`.
Temporary storage folder	Where a recording is written while it runs. A fast drive with enough space is best. Default: the Windows temp folder.

Shortcuts



See the next chapter.

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9. Keyboard shortcuts

The shortcuts work everywhere in Windows, also when mnRekord is in the background.

ACTION	DEFAULT
Record, pause and resume	`F9`
Stop	`F10`
Add marker	`Ctrl` + `M`

To change one, open Preferences → Shortcuts, click the shortcut and press the new key or combination (a function key, a letter or a digit, with `Ctrl`, `Alt` or `Shift` if you like). **Restore defaults** brings back the three above. If another program already owns a shortcut, mnRekord tells you that it could not assign it.

10. Tray icon

While mnRekord runs there is a coral icon in the notification area of the taskbar (it may be in the “hidden icons” group). A left click brings the window back. The right-click menu has:

- **Show mnRekord** – brings the window to the front;
- **Start recording** / **Stop recording** – the entry changes with the state;
- **Quit**.

11. Command line

A second start of `mnrekord.exe` does not open a second window. It hands its arguments to the running copy and exits. If no copy runs, the arguments are executed by the copy that starts. Commands can be written with `/`, `-` or `--` in front, or without, and are not case sensitive; several commands can be given at once.

```
mnrekord setoutputpath "D:\Videos" setscreenframerate 60 record
mnrekord stop
```

COMMAND	EFFECT
`record`	Starts a recording (with the countdown).
`pause`, `resume`	Pause or continue the running recording.
`stop`	Stops and saves, as the Stop button does.
`writetofile`	Stops, saves with an automatic name without asking, and quits.
`drawregion`	Starts “Draw on screen”.
`setregion X Y W H`	Sets the region in screen pixels.
`followwindow "text"`	Selects the first visible window whose title contains the text, records it and follows it.
`setscreenframerate N`	15, 24, 30 or 60.
`setoutputpath "folder"`	Sets the output folder.
`enablescreenrecording`, `disablescreenrecording`	Switch the Screen card on or off.
`unmutesystemaudio`, `mutesystemaudio`	Switch System audio on or off.

One more mode does not use the running copy:

```
mnrekord --gif recording.mp4 recording.gif
```

It converts a recording to a GIF and exits. The result is a text file `recording.gif.log` that says `ok` or what went wrong.

> **Note**
> `setoutputpath`, `setregion`, `setscreenframerate` and the other setting commands are saved in the settings, like changes made in the window.

12. Recovering a recording

A recording is written to the temporary folder while it runs. If mnRekord is closed in an unusual way (a crash, a power cut, the process killed), the next start shows **Recover recording**:

- **Recover** asks where to save the file and keeps what was recorded, up to the last written fragment (a few seconds before the end may be lost);
- **Delete** throws it away.

Until you decide, the unfinished recording stays in the temporary folder, in a folder named `trecRec…`.

13. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	WHAT TO TRY
The Record button is grey, or "Turn on the screen to record"	Switch on the **Screen** card. mnRekord needs the screen; audio alone is not recorded.
"Unable to record system audio"	Connect or enable a playback device in Windows sound settings, then switch System audio on again.
A window is black in the video	Some programs (protected video, some games in exclusive full screen) do not allow screen capture. Run the game in windowed or borderless mode.
The Windows sign-in or permission (UAC) screen is not recorded	That is by design in Windows; it is a protected desktop.
"Not Enough Space On Disk"	Free some space or choose another temporary folder (Preferences → Files). The recording up to that point is saved.
The video stutters on a slow computer	Lower the frame rate or the size, and leave "Use the graphics card to encode" on. Closing programs that use the GPU helps.
A shortcut does nothing	Another program may own it. Pick a different key in Preferences → Shortcuts.
The recorder itself appears in the video	Check that "Do not capture recorder on screen" is on.
The size changed to something I did not choose	With a locked ratio the frame always keeps the ratio. Choose **Free** in the Ratio list to resize without it.

14. Technical notes

- **Capture:** the Windows Desktop Duplication API (DXGI), one duplication per monitor that the region touches; GDI is the fallback. The region is copied at the chosen frame rate; the pointer is drawn on top. Every coordinate is in physical pixels.
- **Video:** frames are converted to NV12 (BT.709, limited range) and encoded with the Media Foundation H.264 encoder, in quality-based rate control. The hardware encoder is used

when available.

- **Audio:** the system sound is captured with WASAPI loopback (48 kHz, stereo) and encoded to AAC at 160 kbit/s. Audio and video follow the same recording clock, so pauses and silence do not shift them against each other.
- **Files:** fragmented MP4, written by the Media Foundation sink writer.
- **Settings:** `%APPDATA%\mnRekord\settings.json`. Delete the file to go back to the defaults.
- **One copy:** a named mutex keeps one running copy; commands go to it over the named pipe `\\.\pipe\mnRekord`.

---

15. Building from source

You need Windows 10 or newer and a current stable Rust toolchain.

```
git clone https://github.com/miklosnemeth/mnRekord
cd mnRekord
cargo test --release
cargo build --release
```

The program is `target\release\mnrekord.exe`. To make the installer, install Inno Setup 6 and run `installer\build.ps1`; the result is `dist\mnRekord-<version>-setup.exe`.

mnRekord is written in Rust with egui and the `windows` crate. It is released under the MIT license.